NGO SUPPORT TOOLKIT · 07

Volunteer Management Starter Kit

Recruit the right volunteers, set them up to succeed, and make them want to come back. A role description template, an onboarding checklist and the essentials of a volunteer agreement.

Free to use and adapt **For** volunteer coordinators and event leads swkghana.org/support · October 2026

THE VOLUNTEER JOURNEY

- Plan the roles, then recruit for them.
- Onboard, support and recognise.
- Say goodbye well, so people come back.

BEFORE YOU RECRUIT

Volunteers give their time, not free labour. Only recruit as many people as you can brief, support and thank properly.

1 Volunteer role description

Write one for every role. It sets expectations on both sides and makes recruitment fairer.

Role title	
Purpose	Why this role matters, in one sentence.
Main tasks	
Skills and qualities	Separate what is essential from what would be nice.
Time and place	Hours, dates and location, or remote.
Training and support	What you will provide, and who they report to.
What they will gain	Skills, experience, certificate, reference.
Safeguarding	Any checks needed, for example for work with children.

Example roles for an event: registration and welcome, logistics and venue, media and content, documentation and reporting. Each needs its own lead and briefing.

2 Recruit fairly

- [ ] Advertise where your volunteers are: your community groups, universities, partners and social media.
- [ ] Keep the application form short, and ask only for data you need.
- [ ] Say how and when you will choose, and stick to it.
- [ ] Choose on skills and commitment, not on who you already know.
- [ ] Reply to everyone who applies, including people you don't select.
- [ ] Keep applicants' data secure, and delete it when no longer needed.

3 Onboarding checklist

- [ ] A warm welcome, and an introduction to your mission and team.
- [ ] Code of conduct and safeguarding policy read and signed.
- [ ] A data protection briefing: what they may and may not share.
- [ ] Training for their specific role.
- [ ] A named supervisor, and a buddy if possible.
- [ ] Contacts list, including what to do in an emergency.
- [ ] Their emergency contact recorded securely.
- [ ] Clear dates, times and what to bring or wear.

4 Support, recognise, and say goodbye well

Support

- Short check-ins, especially in the first weeks.
- Feedback both ways.
- Deal with problems early and privately.

Recognise

- Thank people specifically, for what they did.
- Certificates and references.
- Public thanks, with their consent.

Say goodbye

- An exit conversation: what worked, what didn't.
- Collect equipment, and remove access to accounts.
- Invite them to stay in touch.

5 Volunteer agreement essentials

A short agreement sets expectations. It is not an employment contract, so avoid the language of one, such as fixed hours or pay.

We will

- Explain the role and provide training and support.
- Keep you safe, and cover agreed expenses.
- Treat you fairly and listen to your ideas.
- Recognise your contribution.

You agree to

- Follow our code of conduct and safeguarding policy.
- Keep confidential information private.
- Let us know early if you can't make a commitment.
- Represent the organisation respectfully.

Volunteer name:
Signature:
Date:

For [organisation] :
Signature:
Date:

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